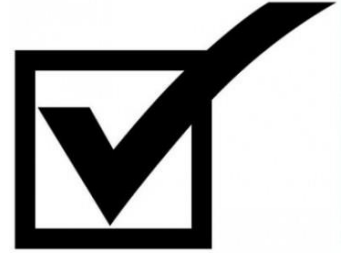




**BUSINESS
PROFESSIONALS**
of **AMERICA**
Giving Purpose to Potential



ETHICS AND PROFESSIONALISM

(540)

STATE 2024

FINAL

Presentation Points _____ **(140 points)**

Specification Points _____ **(20 points)**

TOTAL POINTS _____ **(160 points)**

Preparation Time: 20 minutes

GENERAL GUIDELINES:

Failure to adhere to any of the following rules will result in disqualification:

1. Contestants must hand in this test booklet and all printouts if any.
2. No equipment, supplies, or materials other than those specified for this event are allowed in the testing area. No previous BPA tests and/or sample tests (handwritten, photocopied, or keyed) are allowed in the testing area.
3. Electronic devices will be monitored according to ACT standards.

DESCRIPTION:

Explore the application of ethical frameworks to various aspects used in business today.

STATE FINAL SCENARIO:

You are a supervisor at Digital Solutions. You have an employee who is loyal and does great work and is also a single parent. They have been warned about being tardy to work and excessive absenteeism several times, both verbally and in writing. The last written warning included notice that "further violations could result in disciplinary actions," including suspension or termination.

A short time after the written warning was issued, your employee called work right before their shift began to say they were not going to be in because their babysitter had canceled, and they had no one to care for their young child.

You told them that they had already exceeded the allowed number of absences and warned that if they did not report to work, or find an employee to swap shifts with, they could be suspended without pay or terminated. The employee did not report for their shift, nor did they find an employee to trade shifts with.

How will you handle this situation when the employee returns to work?

A contestant will be DISQUALIFIED for violations of the Copyright and Fair Use Guidelines.

Contestants who do not submit an entry that follows this topic will be disqualified.

Answers will vary, but may include the following from the *Ethics and Professionalism Resources Manual*:

- Professionalism allows for heightened respect from clients, thereby, opening greater lines of communication and potentially increasing trust. A company known for maintaining a level of high ethical and professional standards is typically valued above its peers when competing in the same market.
- Dependability is considered an admirable business ethic. Just how dependable are you? Do you arrive to work on time? Can people trust that you will do what you say?
- Trustworthy: Good business practice requires trust. Neither you nor your business can succeed with a reputation for untrustworthiness. Professionalism plays an important role

in how a person is perceived by his/her employer, his/her co-workers, and casual contacts.

- **Fairness:** Fairness is an important component of ethical business. How you are treated by a superior or how you treat a subordinate directly impacts the quality of work and how work is performed. How fairly you treat others in negotiations or contractually will ultimately affect who is willing to deal with you in the future.
- **Leadership:** Ethical behavior more often than not trickles down from the top. If the leaders of an organization practice good business ethics, chances are better that employees will follow the example.